NSRA Title XXXIX · Digital Government Modernization

# Government That Works Online: Retire the Old Systems, Build One Front Door

The United States ranked **first** in the UN's e-government index in 2003 through 2005. In 2024 it ranked **19th**. Benefit and payment systems built decades ago still run core programs, crash during emergencies, and leak money. Title XXXIX replaces them on a deadline and pays for it from the waste it stops.

## What it does

| Provision | Draft text |
|---|---|
| **Find the old systems** | Every major agency inventories mission-critical systems over 20 years old or on unsupported code within 180 days (Sec. 3902(a)) |
| **Retire them on a deadline** | Seven-year retirement schedule, Social Security, Medicare, Medicaid, veterans', tax, and unemployment payments first (Sec. 3902(b)) |
| **Self-repaying fund** | A Legacy Retirement Account in the Technology Modernization Fund; agencies repay from documented savings (Sec. 3902(c)) |
| **Unemployment systems that hold** | Grants for State systems that handle ten times normal claim volume with built-in fraud detection (Sec. 3902(d)) |
| **One front door** | One secure portal to apply for and manage federal services; with your consent, tell the government once instead of re-entering the same information (Sec. 3903) |
| **Privacy first** | Minimum necessary data, Privacy Act protections, no data sales, no law-enforcement use without a warrant, and in-person and phone options (Sec. 3903(c)–(d)) |
| **Cost** | $5 billion a year for five years, paid first from improper-payment savings (Sec. 3905) |

*Operative text: Title XXXIX (Secs. 3901–3906).*

*Full text: theamericandeal.org/bill-text · This page: theamericandeal.org/digital-government · Contact: contact@theamericandeal.org · Fiscal figures are internal models, not CBO or JCT scores. Drafted by Santonio D. Sanders.*